

Parallax

Radically Different Perspectives,
Helping Each Other Survive

A Cooperative Puzzle-Solving
Platformer with Asymmetric
Perspectives

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Quick Background about Myself:

I am a Philosophy postdoc here at Yale.

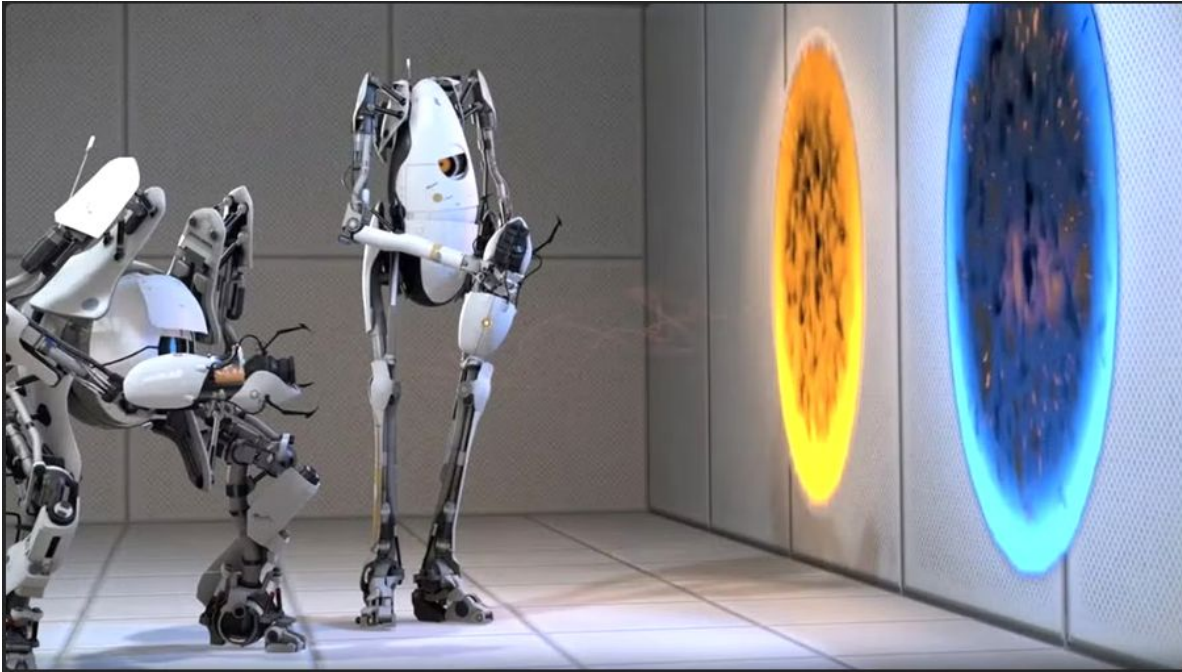
Study the philosophy of physics,
specifically, spacetime dualities.

This game developed out of my research:

- There can be two mathematically equivalent ways of representing the world, which lead to **radically different ways of experiencing the world!**



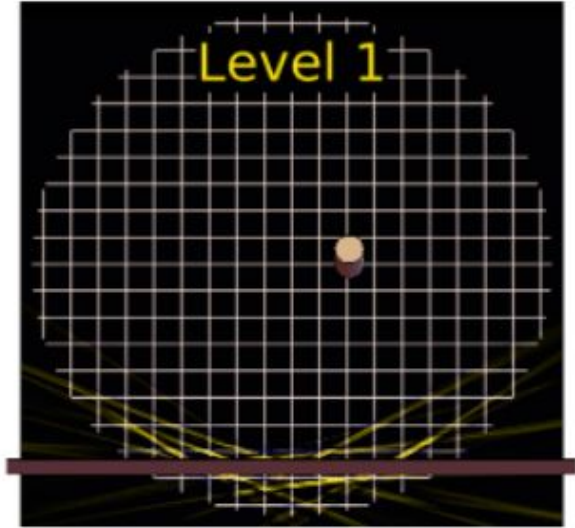
Remember how fun *Portal 2*'s Co-Op Mode was?
But what if it were about **perspectives instead of portals?**



**How can two players
learn to cooperate
when they perceive
reality in fundamentally
different ways?**

Two Dual Perspective: Mobius and Euclid

What Euclid Sees



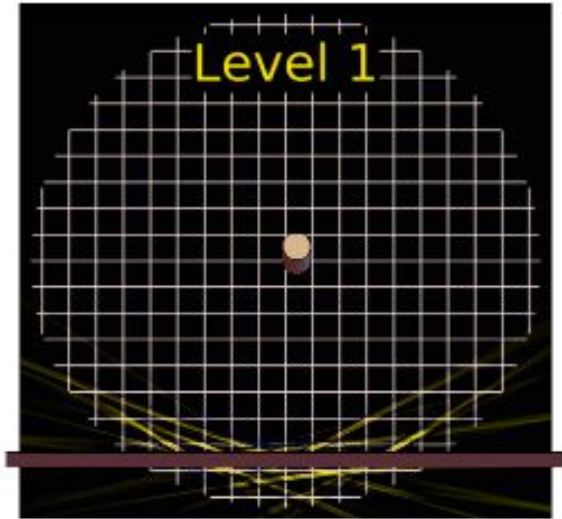
What Mobius Sees



- Both players think of themselves as being a localized cylinder-like objects
- Both players think of each other as being an infinite line-shaped object

Two Dual Perspective: Mobius and Euclid

What Euclid Sees



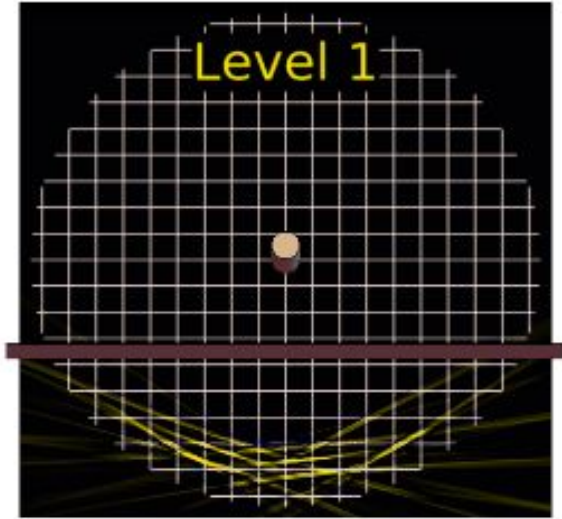
What Mobius Sees



- Euclid thinks he is walking around in the plane and jumping as usual
- But Mobius sees this as a sine-shaped wave doing complex motions!

Two Dual Perspective: Mobius and Euclid

What Euclid Sees



What Mobius Sees



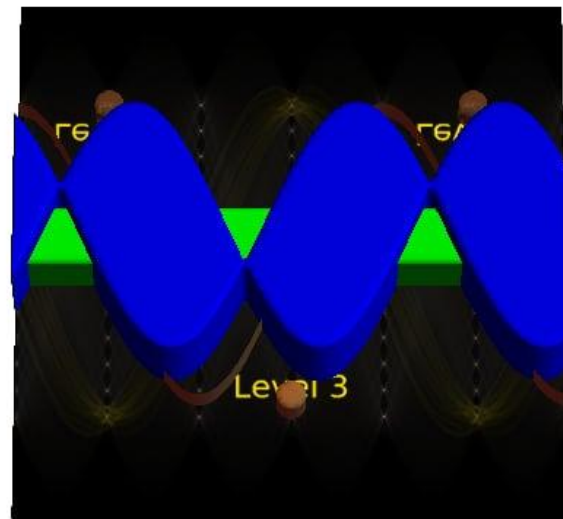
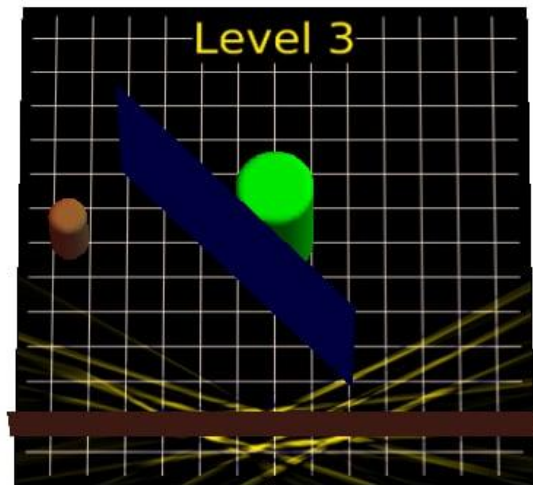
- Mobius thinks he is walking around in the plane and jumping as usual
- But Euclid sees this as an infinite straight line doing complex motions!

What Euclid Sees vs What Mobius Sees

Objects which Euclid sees as a plane and a cylinder, appear more complicated to Mobius.

And vice versa!

Each player can only see one of the two perspectives.



They have to **communicate** and **combine their distinct abilities** to solve puzzles together. (E.g., one player jumps on the other to use as a bridge)

Neat Mechanics, but What is the Story?

There are lots of ideas to explore here!

Possible Philosophical Themes:

- What is observer-independent reality?
- How can people work with radically different perspectives work together?
- Political Allegory: The Big-Bad is an oligarch who has intentionally fractured their views of realities to control them.

The two players must overcome their fundamental differences to overthrow the system that divides them.



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